AHEAD WITH KK

Two-step offers: lift the bill without giving away margin

for clothing, electronics, furniture, any shop that runs "spend X, get Y" offers

What I saw. A menswear store: ₹1,200 off on ₹12,999, and ₹2,000 off on ₹19,999. That's about 9% and then 10%. The bigger offer is barely bigger. My take: it's there to pull a ₹13,000 bill up to ₹20,000.

1. Find your usual bill

- Look at your last 50 bills. What's the typical amount? Write it down.

2. Set step 1 at or just above that number

- Most customers should feel "I'm almost there". If step 1 is far above the usual bill, nobody reaches it.

3. Set step 2 one item above step 1

- The gap should be about one more product: a shirt, a belt, a cable. "Just one more thing" is easy. Doubling the bill is not.

4. Keep the percentage nearly the same

- Like the store: 9% then 10%. The bigger rupee number does the work; your margin stays steady.

5. Show the gap at the counter

- "You're ₹1,800 away from ₹2,000 off." Put this on the bill screen, a small board, or say it at billing. Keep a few add-on items near the counter for that gap.

6. Track it

- Average bill before and after, and how many people hit each step. Remove the offer if bills don't rise.

Practical steps, not guaranteed results. Measure before you keep it.